

Amazon Interview Guide

What I Learned From My Amazon Interview Process

If you are preparing for interviews at Amazon, this guide will help you understand something very important.

Amazon interviews are **not just about coding**.

Yes, DSA matters.

But what Amazon really tries to understand is **how you think, how you solve problems, and how you take ownership**.

During the interview process, I realized that Amazon evaluates candidates using something called **Leadership Principles**.

Once you understand these principles, you will also understand **why interviewers ask certain questions**.

Before we go into the interview rounds, let's first understand these principles.

Why Amazon Cares So Much About Leadership Principles

Amazon has a very strong culture.

They want people who

Take ownership

Think long term

Solve real problems

Work well with teams

That is why every interview round includes **behavioral questions**.

These questions are designed to check if you demonstrate Amazon's **Leadership Principles**.

Even if you solve coding questions correctly, you may still get rejected if you **don't show these behaviours**.

Amazon Leadership Principles

Here are the **14 principles Amazon evaluates candidates on**.

You don't need to memorize them, but you should understand the mindset behind them.

Customer Obsession

Always think about what is best for the customer.

Ownership

Treat the problem like it is your responsibility.

Invent and Simplify

Look for smarter and simpler ways to solve problems.

Are Right, A Lot

Use data and logic to make good decisions.

Learn and Be Curious

Always keep learning new things.

Hire and Develop the Best

Help people around you improve and grow.

Insist on the Highest Standards

Don't settle for average work.

Think Big

Look for solutions that create large impact.

Bias for Action

Take action instead of overthinking.

Frugality

Solve problems with limited resources.

Earn Trust

Be honest, transparent and respectful.

Dive Deep

Understand the problem deeply.

Have Backbone; Disagree and Commit

Share your opinion honestly but support the final decision.

Deliver Results

Focus on actually getting things done.

Amazon Interview Process

The interview process usually has **5 rounds**.

Round 1 – Technical Interview

Round 2 – Technical Interview

Round 3 – Technical Interview

Round 4 – Managerial Interview

Round 5 – Bar Raiser Interview

One thing many students don't realize is that **even technical rounds contain leadership questions**.

Amazon wants engineers who can **code and lead**.

Round 1 – Technical Interview

The first round usually focuses on **basic data structures and problem solving clarity**.

You may get problems based on arrays or linked lists.

Example DSA Questions

Find the first non-repeating element in an array.

Two Sum problem.

Reverse a linked list.

Detect a cycle in a linked list.

Interviewers usually start with a straightforward problem and then ask follow-up questions like

Can you optimize this solution?

How would this behave with large input?

Leadership Question

You may also hear something like

“Tell me about a time you solved a difficult technical problem.”

How You Can Structure Your Answer

You can use a simple framework.

Situation

During my [project / internship / coursework], we faced [problem].

Task

My responsibility was to [your role].

Action

I analyzed the problem and implemented [solution].

Result

This resulted in [improvement / learning / outcome].

Round 2 – Technical Interview

The second round usually focuses more on **optimization and deeper problem solving**.

Interviewers may expect you to think about **HashMaps and time complexity improvements**.

Example DSA Questions

Two Sum optimized using HashMap.

Longest substring without repeating characters.

Group anagrams.

Top K frequent elements.

In many cases, interviewers want to see **how you move from brute force to optimized solutions**.

Leadership Question

“Tell me about a time when you took ownership of a problem.”

Template You Can Use

Situation

During [project / internship], we faced [challenge].

Task

Even though it was not directly assigned to me, I decided to take responsibility.

Action

I worked with [team / stakeholders] and implemented [solution].

Result

The final outcome was [impact / improvement].

Round 3 – Technical Interview

This round often includes **tree problems, recursion or backtracking**.

Interviewers are more interested in your **thinking process** than just the final code.

Example DSA Questions

Binary tree level order traversal.

Lowest common ancestor in a binary tree.

Generate all subsets.

Combination sum.

Word search using backtracking.

Leadership Question

“Tell me about a time when you disagreed with a teammate.”

Template You Can Follow

Situation

During [project], there was disagreement regarding [decision].

Task

My goal was to ensure the best outcome for the project.

Action

I explained my reasoning using [data / logic] and listened to other perspectives.

Result

We agreed on [solution], which resulted in [positive outcome].

Round 4 – Managerial Interview

This round is more focused on **how you work with people and how you make decisions**.

Coding questions usually stop here.

Common Questions

Tell me about a challenging project.

How do you prioritize tasks when there are multiple deadlines?

Tell me about a time you failed.

How do you handle disagreements in a team?

Template for Freshers

Situation

During my [college project / internship], we faced [problem].

Task

My responsibility was to [role].

Action

I worked with my team and implemented [solution].

Result

The outcome was [result or lesson learned].

Template for Experienced Candidates

Situation

While working at [company], we faced [business problem].

Task

As a [role], I was responsible for [responsibility].

Action

I analyzed the issue and implemented [solution].

Result

This improved [performance / efficiency / reliability].

Round 5 – Bar Raiser Interview

This is usually the **most important round**.

The interviewer here ensures that the candidate meets Amazon's **hiring bar**.

Expect deeper questions and more follow ups.

Common Questions

Why should we hire you?

Tell me about a mistake you made.

Tell me about a time you demonstrated leadership.

Explain a complex technical concept to a non-technical person.

Template

Situation

In [project / workplace], we faced [problem].

Task

I was responsible for solving the issue.

Action

I took initiative and implemented [solution].

Result

This resulted in [impact / improvement] and taught me [learning].

DSA Patterns You Should Focus On

Instead of solving hundreds of random questions, focus on mastering these patterns.

Arrays and Two Pointer techniques

Sliding Window

HashMap frequency problems

Linked List manipulation

Binary Tree traversal (DFS / BFS)

Backtracking

Recursion

Graph traversal

Dynamic Programming basics

Final Advice

The biggest lesson from my interview experience was this.

Companies like Amazon don't just hire people who can **write code**.

They hire people who can

Think clearly

Communicate their ideas

Take ownership of problems

If you build these skills along with DSA, you will be ready not just for Amazon, but for most product companies.

30 DSA Questions to Practice for Amazon Interviews

These questions cover the **core patterns Amazon usually tests**.

Arrays & HashMap

1. Two Sum
2. Best Time to Buy and Sell Stock
3. Product of Array Except Self
4. First Non Repeating Element in an Array
5. Subarray with Given Sum
6. Longest Consecutive Sequence

Sliding Window

7. Longest Substring Without Repeating Characters
 8. Minimum Window Substring
 9. Maximum Sum Subarray of Size K
 10. Longest Repeating Character Replacement
-

Linked List

- 11. Reverse a Linked List
 - 12. Detect Cycle in Linked List
 - 13. Merge Two Sorted Linked Lists
 - 14. Remove Nth Node From End
 - 15. Intersection of Two Linked Lists
-

Trees

- 16. Binary Tree Level Order Traversal
 - 17. Maximum Depth of Binary Tree
 - 18. Lowest Common Ancestor in Binary Tree
 - 19. Validate Binary Search Tree
 - 20. Serialize and Deserialize Binary Tree
-

Backtracking

- 21. Generate Subsets
 - 22. Generate Permutations
 - 23. Combination Sum
 - 24. Word Search
-

Graphs

- 25. Number of Islands
 - 26. Clone Graph
 - 27. Course Schedule
-

Dynamic Programming

- 28. Climbing Stairs

29. Coin Change

30. Longest Increasing Subsequence

30 Amazon Leadership Principle Questions to Practice

These questions are asked across **technical, managerial, and bar raiser rounds**.

Customer Obsession

1. Tell me about a time you improved something for a user or customer.
 2. Describe a situation where you had to prioritize customer needs over internal convenience.
-

Ownership

3. Tell me about a time you took ownership of a problem.
 4. Describe a situation where something went wrong and you took responsibility.
-

Invent and Simplify

5. Tell me about a time you created a simpler solution to a complex problem.
 6. Describe a situation where you improved a process.
-

Are Right, A Lot

7. Tell me about a decision you made using data.
 8. Describe a time when your judgment helped solve a problem.
-

Learn and Be Curious

9. Tell me about a new skill you learned recently.
 10. Describe a time you had to learn something quickly.
-

Hire and Develop the Best

- 11. Tell me about a time you helped someone improve.
 - 12. Describe how you supported a teammate's growth.
-

Insist on High Standards

- 13. Tell me about a time when you refused to compromise on quality.
 - 14. Describe a time when you improved the quality of a project.
-

Think Big

- 15. Tell me about a time when you proposed a big idea.
 - 16. Describe a situation where you aimed for a long-term impact.
-

Bias for Action

- 17. Tell me about a time when you took quick action.
 - 18. Describe a situation where acting fast helped solve a problem.
-

Frugality

- 19. Tell me about a time you achieved results with limited resources.
 - 20. Describe how you solved a problem efficiently.
-

Earn Trust

- 21. Tell me about a time you built trust with a team.
 - 22. Describe a situation where transparency helped resolve an issue.
-

Dive Deep

- 23. Tell me about a time when you investigated a problem deeply.
 - 24. Describe how you identified the root cause of a problem.
-

Disagree and Commit

- 25. Tell me about a time you disagreed with someone.
 - 26. Describe how you handled a conflict in a team.
-

Deliver Results

- 27. Tell me about a challenging goal you achieved.
 - 28. Describe a time when you met a tight deadline.
-

General Leadership Questions

- 29. Tell me about your biggest professional failure.
- 30. Tell me about a time you demonstrated leadership.